

ANGEL ACTION · BREATHING

Asthma Attack — 4 x 4 x 4 Plan

Sit the person upright, give 4 puffs of a blue reliever puffer through a spacer (1 puff at a time, 4 breaths each), wait 4 minutes, repeat if no improvement. Call 000 if symptoms do not improve.

Recognise an asthma attack

- Wheezing, persistent cough, tight chest
- Difficulty speaking in full sentences
- Anxiety, pale, sweaty skin
- Blue lips, exhaustion — call **000 immediately**

Asthma First Aid Plan (4 x 4 x 4)

1. **Sit the person upright.** Stay calm and reassuring.
2. Give **4 separate puffs** of a blue/grey reliever (e.g. Ventolin, Asmol) — one puff at a time, taking **4 breaths** from a spacer after each puff. Use a spacer if available.
3. **Wait 4 minutes.**
4. If there is no improvement, give another **4 puffs**.
5. If there is still no improvement, **call 000** and keep giving 4 puffs every 4 minutes until the ambulance arrives.

Severe attack — call 000 first

Call 000 immediately if:

- The person is struggling to breathe.
- Their lips look blue.
- They have collapsed.
- There is no reliever available.

While waiting for the ambulance, keep giving 4 puffs every 4 minutes.

Adrenaline (anaphylaxis with asthma)

If the person also has an EpiPen and a known severe allergy, give the **adrenaline first**, then the asthma reliever. See **anaphylaxis**.

Adapted from Australian First Aid 5th Edition. Get the full guide and live CPR metronome at firstaidangel.org.